

PRD: Spotify Library

Product: Spotify Mobile and Desktop

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Problem

Spotify has no native library concept. Users can save songs to Liked Songs or add them to playlists, but there is no way to build a single unified collection of everything you love across all your playlists. Liked Songs exists but is not intuitive, many users do not discover it until years into using the app. The result is that users who want to shuffle across their entire music catalog have no native way to do it.

I spent time manually going through every playlist I had built and adding each song one by one into a playlist I created called "all my songs" just to have a place to shuffle my full catalog. That playlist now has over 6,000 songs. The fact that I built this workaround myself is a sign that Spotify is missing something Apple Music already has.

User evidence

A manually curated 6,000 song playlist built as a workaround for a missing native feature demonstrates clear unmet need. Apple Music's library feature is frequently cited by users who switch between platforms as one of the features they miss most when moving to Spotify.

Proposed solution

Add a Library toggle at the song level. When adding a song to a playlist, users see an option to also add it to their Library. The Library lives as its own destination in the app alongside Liked Songs and playlists, and can be shuffled, sorted, and filtered independently. Everyone listens differently and has different preferences, so users have full control over what lives in their Library and adding a song to a playlist does not automatically add it to the Library.

Success metrics

Adoption rate of the Library feature among active users. Reduction in the number of users creating large catch all playlists as a workaround. Increase in shuffle sessions originating from Library versus individual playlists.

Out of scope

This does not replace Liked Songs or existing playlists. Existing playlists do not automatically populate the Library on launch, users opt songs in going forward.